

Overview

- The Faceless Mother is starving. Her worshippers, whom either owe her their life or owe their loved one's life, will ensure she feeds
- She lures prey with her orbs of light, infecting their minds before consuming their consciousness. This will happen on the last day of "Camp Delima"
- This 4-day charity camp is hosted by Air Terjun Riam Parangek at Pontianak. The waterfall campsite is simply the venue. The event was truly incited and organised by the Kehidupan Kedua charity: the public face of the Cult of the Faceless (ironically) whose members are there as volunteers
- The Mother naturally resides in wooded areas and travels through shadows. This is why Kehidupan Kedua pushed for this event at this location
- Volunteers will not differentiate themselves from the waterfall campsite staff members to minimise suspicion and to throw off the "researchers" (Agents) from an organisation they have encountered before. The event is also not marketed as a charity event to reduce correlation to Kehidupan Kedua

Briefing

Location: Jakarta HQ

2 May 2011

Director Mulyani calls Agent AJ into her office before the rest of the agents. She knows AJ has read the previous Operasi RAYAP documents and knows why he is in Melati. She informs him the Red Jasmine Ecotourism branch have found an advertisement about a 4-day camp that features "the possible sightings of extremely rare, very radiant, mystical fireflies". For this reason, she's reopening Operasi RAYAP -- but she wants to ensure AJ is mentally strong and capable enough to take on this personal operation.

She warns him that she will give the rest of the team a copy of the previous RAYAP documents -- his involvement with previous initialisations of Operasi RAYAP will be revealed, though not under the name "AJ". Additionally, besides this being possibly be a false lead, he may not get any closure or the closure he wants.

Afterwards, she calls in the other agents to brief them, repeating what she has said. She informs them they will be travelling to Air Terjun Riam Parangek at Pontianak, Kalimantan tomorrow. The name of the company that manages the tourist site is the same as the waterfall and are the ones hosting the camp. It will last from May 4 to May 7, with the lights appearing at night on May 7, and the guests leaving on May 8.

She'll give the agents a copy of previous RAYAP documents. Equipment and gear will be supplied at the Pontianak headquarters. Agents are free to bring their own equipment and make other preparations/research before leaving. She has also approved use of the **Obsidian Keris**.

On May 3, Kiara will provide the team with the Keris and other requested equipment/gear before sending them to the airport. She says if she joins an operation without permission, Director Mulyani will fire her. In Pontianak, a Bulan agent will be their driver. Agents have the whole day to make preparations for the camp and the 6-hour drive from Pontianak to the very remote waterfall in the mountains. They will leave at 6am.

As Vikal has previously wielded the Keris, if he wields it again for this operation, he will feel its cold, dark bloodlust run through his veins (**SAN 1/0**). For a moment, he craves carnal power. He can willingly lose **SAN** to meditate upon this bloodlust to reveal the Keris' true potential to himself.

The Truth

All **guests** are perfectly unaware civilians, consisting mostly of teenage or young-adult friends and couples, along with families with older children. They are a mix of expats, tourists, and locals. The **staff** off Air Terjun Riam Parangek are meant to be red herrings: some quick, thorough investigation can prove their innocence. But before the Agents can do that, they will first have to differentiate the staff from the **volunteers** of Camp Delima. The volunteers are from the charity Kehidupan Kedua who organised this camp event to -- but they never make this known for good reason.

The Faceless Mother

Nothing is known about this creature: how old she is, how she came to be, or from where she came from. Not even her true name or identity is known -- she bears the name that her followers have given her -- as she does not speak. Her only form of communication compatible with humans are her emotions expressed through the **amalgamation of disarranged human features** that make up her form, and the nightmares induced in those she slowly feeds on.

This, combined with her cycle of hunting, feasting, and resting in the Earth may make her seem unintelligent. However, having consumed many human consciousnesses, she understands her prey well enough to know what humans respond to: light in darkness, voices of familiar ones, and other mundane things. Her **orbs of light** not only entrance humans, but also infects their minds to prepare them for consumption.

The infection allows the Mother to slowly consume the human's consciousness in their sleep. To the human, this manifests as what starts as strange, sparse dreams of a faceless, black, skeletal monster kidnapping the human's loved ones. This rapidly plummets into daily vivid nightmares, making the human manic and sleep-deprived either from being too scared to sleep, being unable to stay asleep, or both. The final nightmare is the human dreaming they are the monster themselves. The next time the human falls asleep, they will fall into a coma-like state. The Mother's consumption is complete.

The human will not be brain dead: despite dulling over years, the brain regions related to dreaming, the five senses, and emotions are active -- though the human is expressionless and fully unresponsive. Their vitals and reflexes are fully normal as well (eg: some who fall into this coma-like state with their eyes open continue blinking). As the human is not dead yet, their consciousness has not faded, letting the Mother can feed on it for a prolonged period of time. Putting the human on life support further extends this.

For each human consciousness she feeds on, a tumour resembling the human's face stretches atop her thin, black skeleton with far too many ribs, far too many vertebrae, and far too many limbs. These tumours do not function like humans, but are minimally responsive and are most certainly alive. Together, they form a hivemind of consciousnesses capable of recognising people and begging for help -- the Mother senses this and will target the recognised person so they may join the hivemind.

The tumours decay over time along with their consciousness and sense of self. When a dead human's consciousness is fully depleted, or when a comatose human dies and their lingering

consciousness is fully depleted, the Mother moults -- the face of the human falls off. They have fully forgotten who they were. They will not last long.

When resting in the day, the Mother burrows into a shaded patch of Earth with her many limbs. She can travel great distances very quickly in this manner from shadow to shadow. This is why **she only emerges at night**. While she prefers wooded areas to scale trees like a spider, she can emerge anywhere with solid ground as long it is in shadow.

The Cult of the Faceless

It is unknown when the Cult of the Faceless first emerged, but it must have been when someone discovered the Faceless Mother is capable of restoring vitality into a severely ill or a dead person. Spindling the human in her arms, the Mother fuses the person's face with one of its tumours. Over a few days in the Mother's arms, the person will assume the tumour's human form, and the person's vitality is restored by the tumour's consciousness. The tumour's personality fully replacing theirs, and the tumour's memories and mental skills fuses with theirs. This can result in gaining new knowledge, understanding a different language, and the like. The person's new form will adjust to the person's current age and will continue to age normally.

The cult gathers large groups of people to sacrifice for their Mother's periodic feast so that she may bring back their dead or heal their sick. This also benefits the cult as there are now more 'consciousnesses' to 'help' others. Over time, this led to the Mother enforcing a quota for her meals the cult must meet, or else she will track those she 'saved' to consume their consciousness and their body, along with anyone else around them. Victims have their heads shrunk and shrivelled like prunes, with their faces completely gone and their brains digested. Their consciousness is consumed as normal and grows on the Mother.

The cult leaders ensure no one ever leaves the cult. This is not a large issue as almost all the cult members go insane after what they have witnessed, fully accepting and complying with the Mother's way of life. There are very few sane members who regret their actions. These doubtful ones who get caught will be fed to the Mother.

Today, they are publicly known as the charity Kehidupan Kedua and investment company Biji Muda.

Kehidupan Kedua

Founded in the 70s, Kehidupan Kedua is the cult's most active front. The charity focuses on supporting the financially lacking to pay off their palliative care and funerals, wishing to reduce the emotional strain of economic stress. They also focus on giving resources, counselling, and other support to anyone whose loved one recently passed away. Though they accept donations from anyone, they do not accept volunteers with the reasoning of the sensitive matter they deal with requires specialised training. The true reason is because all members of Kehidupan Kedua are part of the cult.

The charity specifically targets this demographic as they are the ones who are most likely to be enlisted into the cult. Having an ill or deceased loved one get a second chance at life by taking a healthy body can be more appealing than crushing debt. Those who show too much suspicion will be told the Truth and threatened. Those who still deny their Mother will be kidnapped and fed to her. This is how the Cult of the Faceless operates and spreads in present time.

Camp Delima's guests are to be sacrificed to their Mother. This is why the charity did not want their name attached to the event. All campers eventually falling into a coma *except* for the charity members will surely draw attention.

Biji Muda

Biji Muda is a much younger and much more inactive almost-shell company. Founded in the 90s to gain more revenue, Biji Muda aimed to invest in and/or sponsor start-up companies, small businesses, personal projects, and the like ran by young people, taking advantage of their inexperience, overzealousness, and small size to sacrifice to the cult's Mother.

For this reason, Biji Muda sponsored the Fish & Chips concert and dispatched personnel to help manage it. However, the electronics at the concert venue made the Mother's feast far more destructive than intended. While this made for a good cover that takes blame off their hands, it would be risky to pull the same stunt twice and make a pattern.

Biji Muda withdrew from the public after this event, pretending it never happened, and continued to sponsor Kehidupan Kedua as they have since the company was conceived.

Welcome to Camp Delima

Location: Air Terjun Riam Parangek, Pontianak

What once used to be uneven ground has been cleared and flattened to accommodate vehicles. The Agents have to drive along a dirt path that runs from the main mountainside road to the entrance area, which is wide enough for vehicles to continue driving all the way to the river. Structures at the entrance line the side of this path. Behind the structures are a forest of thin trees.

The dirt terrain throughout the entrance area is flat to accommodate vehicles. **Parking** would normally be here, but because of the large number of campers, the entrance is a drop-off point and an empty plot of land quite a distance away acts as a **temporary parking lot**.

Most structures here are open-air wooden shacks or gazebos: they have no walls, and their roofs are made of either straw or corrugated metal. Lighting is extremely sparse, with the office being the only illuminated structure.

Being closest to the main road, the **entrance** is the only area with **reception**. However, it is still weak. Only text messages and phone calls can go in and out -- roll **LUCK** to see if the Agents are able to do this. The only place to get stable and guaranteed reception and internet access is the **office**.

Pontianak rains all year around. **Roll LUCK for rain** throughout the day: morning, noon, evening, and night. After rain passes, the terrain will be wet, muddy, and/or slippery for a day. Camp activities may still be run with rain within reason.

The Agents cannot distinguish between staff and volunteers, unless they have singled out individuals. Refer to both as **staff** or some other term

The Entrance

On the left is the **canteen** shack that has benches, tables, and a stand selling cheap local snacks and drinks. Next to it is the **kitchen** shack, where food is prepared and stored. The scent of roasting food

wafts into the open with smoke (breakfast = 6am, lunch = after an activity, dinner = 6pm). Close to the river, a concrete building **storage** for rafting equipment (rafts, oars, life vests, helmets), tires to float in the river with, an air pump station, tents, sleeping bags, hammocks, and tarps.

On the right side are few more benches and tables outside the canteen. The **washing rooms** has sinks, squatting toilets, and sitting toilets. It is walled, but is open enough to let a breeze run through. In each stall is bucket of water under a tap and a pail to flush. Next to the bathroom are **shower stalls**: some indoor, some outdoor. The indoor stalls have buckets and pails like the washing rooms, while the outdoor stalls have that and a rudimentary shower head. Near the river is the **office**.

The Office

On the other side is the **office**: newly built, it is the only structure made out of concrete with a corrugated metal roof. It is suspended above ground on stilts. **Below** the office, staff sleep on hammocks tied to the stilts or on the wooden platform. Some miscellaneous items, such as water gallons, lamps, and first aid, are stored on the platform too.

Stairs lead to the **upper level**, whose rooms have holes above their doors for air circulation. There is a bathroom with a shower with running water. Next to it is the actual **office room**. Without being accompanied by a staff member, **LOCKPICKING** is needed to break in. Failing within 10% opens the door, but breaks the lock. A fumble breaks the lock without opening the door.

 *Eine Kleiner Elevatormuzik - Half Life: Alyx*

The office room is quite sparse for its size. There is a desk with a **landline** with a stable connection, a printer, and a bulky **computer** connected to an ethernet -- this is the only "internet" access. It is locked: an Agent will need a secondary device (laptop, Raspberry Pi, USB with malware, etc) to use **COMPSCI/SIGINT** to hack into the computer. It is logged into a Facebook page, where Air Terjun Riam Parangek is promoted, and into an email account where correspondence with touring agencies or individuals are made. **INDO** can be used to easily locate an exchange about the "Camp Delima" outreach program with a charity "Kehidupan Kedua". The exchange also includes Kehidupan Kedua requesting not to attach their name to the event as an act of Good Samaritanism.

SEARCH directs the Agent's attention to the desk's drawer. The desk's drawer has an **accounting book** with records dating less than a year back. **ACCOUNTING** reveals an influx of purchases with foodstuff and tents, their dates leading up to present time. This was fully funded by "Biji Muda". Agent AJ can make an **INT** check to recognise the name as one of the companies who sponsored Fish & Chip's concert.

The Agent will also find a copy of the camp's itinerary, a map of the camp site and waterfall, a map of Pontianak, and the legal documents relating to the ownership of property. Having **SEARCH** 60% reveals a slip of paper tucked between the legal documents, containing the login for the computer and email.

Connecting Kehidupan Kedua and Biji Muda

The Agents can make a quick search into either Kehidupan Kedua or Biji Muda. No check is needed to notice Kehidupan Kedua's **website** thanking Biji Muda for their constant patronage. Biji Muda also seem to have no activity besides advertising their services that assist "young entrepreneurs with

bright futures". There is a small compilation of small, start-up businesses ran by young people with a broad range of focuses. There is no mention of the Fish & Chips concert.

INT and 30 minutes is required to sift through the internet to reveal when Biji Muda started funding Kehidupan Kedua. While Kehidupan Kedua was founded in the 70s, Biji Muda is significantly younger, being founded in the 90s. They begun funding Kehidupan Kedua almost immediately. Agents may notice how the charity does not align with everything else Biji Muda funds.

Inside the Camp

Welcoming you is a banner stretched across two trees, reading "Taman kecil dari Surga". Open gazebos and shacks integrated with the slim but sturdy trees that populate the area.

The flat, entrance area ends at the welcome banner in front of the **river**. Here, the terrain is made up of naturally uneven dirt. The ground here is more moist due to the river and the cool breeze generated by the **waterfall**. Due to the trees, vehicles are unable to pass through here.

There is no reception inside the camp. Besides the sun and moon, there are no other sources of light. Staff members discourage lamps to be lit as it attracts many of the river's local residents: bugs. The **bonfire** is also put out for safety before everyone sleeps.

The ground is littered with dry leaves, branches, and stray rocks. Moving through this without sound calls for **STEALTH**. **After and during rain**, soil turns into mud. This can leave tracks in the mud, or a trail of mud when moving to dryer ground.

The Campsite

Turning left follows the river of the Riam Parang waterfalls downstream. There is a small **treehouse** with stairs at the bend. It overlooks the entrance area and the campsite. The actual **campsite** is set in the area along the river and among the trees. Staff will keep camp closer to the entrance and will not allow guests to camp further downstream in the **forest** for safety.

Within this area, guests are free to choose where to pitch their **tents** or where to tie their **hammocks**, whether it's among the trees or closer to the river. Lining the riverside are a few **gazebos** with elevated wooden platforms, some of which overlook a smaller waterfall. In the gazebos, guests can either loiter here or pitch their tents here. There are also **small tables and stools** along the river.

Mosquitos are very common here. Spiders and snails can be found around trees and rocks, and dragonflies can be found skirting along the river. At **night**, laron (flying termites) and even more mosquitos emerge. Both, especially the former, are attracted to light to mate. **After rain**, many bugs emerge: mosquitos, snails, millipedes, and worms. Ants and flies are attracted to **food**, especially sweet food and drinks for the former.

The Bonfire

 *Fireflies Acoustic Instrumental - Guus Dielissen*

At the centre of the campsite, a small clearing has been made for a small bonfire that is lit every **night**, to ensure a fire doesn't spread. Guests are welcome to pull chairs over or to set up their own, and to cook provided snacks over the fire. It is extinguished at **9pm**.

The Forest

🎵 *Severed from the Vortessence - Half-Life: Alyx*

Beyond the campsite is the forest that follows the river. The same bugs from the campsite can be found here, and the same conditions for **STEALTH** and tracks hold as well. Additionally, running calls for **DEX** to zig-zag past thin trees and to avoid tripping on loose rocks. In the **day**, this is where the **trekking** activity is held.

At **night**, **volunteers** patrol the area to ensure no one leaves and to catch anyone looking for trouble. They do this without light for fear of being suspicious, as everyone is assumed to sleep through the night. Under complete darkness, this gives Agents **STEALTH** +20%.

The Agents stray deep enough into the forest to the point of not being able to see the camp or the volunteers. Any sources of light they bring will not be detected by the volunteers well. Here, they can find evidence of the **Mother** -- she has been moulting, indicating her feasting cycle should start soon. The Mother too will be aware of the Agents' presence.

The Waterfall

Turning right leads to an uneven path made up of wet mud and rocks. The path lies between the river and the **forest**. It is narrow: people will have to walk in a single file. However, it is still broad enough to allow a raft to be dragged along. No checks need to be made when traversing through it normally, though running calls for **DEX** to avoid slipping and falling.

A minute or two of trekking upstream reveals the path breaking into a rocky area near the foot of the largest waterfall in the area. Due to the drop, the strong breeze is wet and the river's downstream current is strong. This is where **rafting** begins.

At night, the **Mother** is more likely to be found in the forest, but she can certainly pursue her prey here.

Encountering the Faceless Mother

🎵 *Terin #6 - Half Life: Alyx*

If the Agents discover the **Mother's** presence, she will lure them to her. Because Kentaro's and Dani's consciousnesses both recognise AJ and are still fuelling the Mother, she will target AJ. All Agents will hear a cluster of distorted but undeniably human voices like static (**SAN** 0/1). However, AJ hears Kentaro (if not moulting) and Dani crying for help.

-- *for AJ's eyes only*

It is unmistakable: Kentaro's and Dani's mourning cries ring like bells in your skull. Take **SAN** 1/1D4 instead.

Agents think the voices come from deep in the forest, away from the river. The Mother will ensure they will take the bait with her **orbs of light**, and then **feast** on those entranced. Attacking the orbs of light does nothing.

Ask the Agents to roll SAN before describing the Mother. The faces stretched over her express what she feels through expressions or voices. She can only be reduced to 1 POW as Dani still lives.

One orb of light vanishes. Then a second. Then a third. One by one, all the orbs of light are swallowed by the night.

And then the darkness grows and comes to life. Around you, the shadows of trees lengthen into crooked spindles, splitting and then fanning out like sickly, needle-like firs of a pine tree. These one, two, four, spider-like legs -- no, centipede-like appendages are what you first see clawing out of the dark soil. They span their fingers and clamp the ground, pushing the rest of its bulging mass of diseased flesh out of the ground.

You feel the earth shake as she emerges. Then you hear many voices moan in unison like a religious chant. Trees sway, letting moonlight illuminate the patchwork of disfigured human face stretched over each other like dough. A mosaic of tens of lopsided angry eyes stare at you. Their mouths hang open, never needing to take a breath for lungs that do not exist.

The faces' voice grow louder and their eyes grow larger. Simultaneously lupine and insectoid, the Mother haunches on all of its limbs, ready to wrap you in her embrace.

The Faceless Mother

STR 25 **CON** n/a **DEX** 20 **INT** 12 **POW** 45

HP n/a **WP** n/a **SAN** n/a

ARMOUR: 0-3 points of armour (see **LIFE SOURCE**)

SKILLS: Stream of Consciousness 80% (see **STREAM OF CONSCIOUSNESS**)

ATTACKS: Discipline, damage 15% Lethality

Embrace 60% (see **EMBRACE**)

Feast, damage 1 POW and 1/1D6 SAN (see **FEAST**)

Lash 40%, damage 1D12

DISCIPLINE: The similar process as Miracle of Life occurs, except the target will not have another consciousness swapped in. Discipline has the intent to kill. The target takes 15% Lethality per round until their consciousness is fully absorbed. When the target dies, their face grows on the Mother's body and adds 1 POW. The target's head, digested, will be shrivelled like a prune. Being freed of the Mother's embrace (see **EMBRACE**) stops this process immediately.

EMBRACE: The Mother's limbs wrap around the target, pressing them to herself, and consumes their head (see **DISCIPLINE**). She can only pin one target at a time this way and cannot move until she releases the target. The target may attempt an opposed STR test. Dealing at least 5 damage at a time also forces her to release her target.

FEAST: Rapidly shifting through shadows, the Mother will attempt feast on targets entranced by her Orbs of Light. This is treated as a contest between the Mother's POW and the target's POW. If the Mother wins, she absorbs 1 POW from the target. The target loses 1/1D6 SAN and collapses, unconscious. If the Mother loses, the target breaks out of their trance. This can only happen once per night.

INHUMAN STATS: A test of a stat with a score of 20 or higher is a critical success on any roll up to the stat's score, and on any roll of matching digits except 100, which fumbles.

LIFE SOURCE: Use the Mother's POW instead of her HP, with each POW point representing a consumed consciousness. Being attacked causes face-tumours to fall only if the face's human is already dead. If the human is still alive, the face will not fall off. At 40+ POW, the faces are layered enough to give ARMOUR 3. At 20 POW, she has ARMOUR 2. At 10 POW, she has ARMOUR 1. At 0 POW, her skeleton disintegrates.

MIRACLE OF LIFE: When offered a sacrifice, the Mother cocoons the target with her limbs. Her faces part to allow her to swallow the target's head. Over 3 days, the Mother digests the target's consciousness and replaces it with another one of hers simultaneously. After this, the target's face replaces what face was once on the Mother. The target's physical appearance, stats, and personality is replaced with the face's. Age adjusts accordingly. Divide the sum of the target's old CON and the face's CON by two: this is the target's new CON. The face's memories and mental skills merge with the target's: keep the higher of overlapping mental skills. The target suffers SAN 1D4/1D10.

ORBS OF LIGHT: Before she makes herself scene, the Mother sends out her Orbs of Light. Everyone who sees the lights must make a POW check. Those who fail are entranced and will approach the Mother (see **FEAST**). Oblivious to their surroundings, breaking out of a trance requires another POW check from the target(s) on their turn.

RESILIENT: The Mother cannot be hurt; she can only be weakened. A successful Lethality roll does not destroy her, but inflicts POW damage equal to the lethality rating.

SCUTTLE: The Mother has multiple limbs covered in fleshy, bulging tumours. This allows her to travel up and along surfaces rapidly. She can move 10m as a free action, or 30m as an action.

STREAM OF CONSCIOUSNESS: The faces' memories, skills, and the like are under the Mother's possession as long they remain on her. She is able to recall information, recognise and track those the faces knew, and the like. Additionally, she is also able to identify those she has given life to (see **MIRACLE OF LIFE**) and track them in the same way.

SHADOW EARTH: Darkness is the Mother's domain, on the surface or underground. As an action, she can tunnel into ground covered by shadow. As another action, she can emerge from any shadow-casted area, anywhere. This is how she is able to travel across Indonesia rapidly.

UNNATURAL BIOLOGY: Beneath the Mother's faces lie no discernible organs or anatomy except its thin, pitch-black, static-like blur that makes up its "skeleton". Making a called shot for "vitals" or another apparently vulnerable area inflicts normal damage, with no special game effect.

SAN LOSS: 1D4/1D10

At 1 POW, only Dani's face remains. The Mother cowers but does not back down, whimpering but snarling like an injured dog. The Agents should realise that further pursuing her is redundant. If they retreat, the Mother will not give chase.

As the Agents flee, describe what they leave behind: the many moulted faces on the ground, blood-soaked soil, chips in trees made by stray bullets, bodies they leave behind, and anything else. The volunteers will collect the moulted faces and burn them to remove evidence of their Mother -- they know most are blind to her grace and will violently reject her and her children. However, if any corpses remain, whether friend or foe, volunteers will report and blame the Agents after campers leave.

As life support is the only reason Dani is alive, **killing Dani will kill the Faceless Mother**. The moment AJ gets reception, Novri's call chimes in. Frantically sobbing, she tells Agent AJ that Dani's heart had suddenly weakened drastically. The nurse is on her way. She asks AJ where he is and begs him to come home -- more for his sake than for her's or Dani's.

The Cultists of the Faceless

There is a chance that the Agents may have to fight volunteers whether due to being abducted, being ambushed, initiating a fight, or others.

Kehidupan Kedua Volunteer, aka Cultist of the Faceless Mother

STR 10 CON 10 DEX 10 INT 10 POW 10 CHA 10

HP 10 WP 10 SAN 30

SKILLS: Alertness 30%, Indonesian 50%, other Language 50%, Navigate 30%, Occult 20%, Survival 30%, Unnatural 10%

ATTACKS: Unarmed 40%, damage 1D4-1.
Heavy flashlight 40%, damage 1D4.
Pocket knife 30%, damage 1D4, AP 3.

The Agents may also encounter Stefanus and/or Maria as well. Maria will avoid physical confrontation at all costs except to protect her son.

Maria Firmanda, Fearful Mother

STR 10 CON 10 DEX 10 INT 18 POW 15 CHA 14

HP 10 WP 15 SAN 65

SKILLS: Anthropology 80%, English 50%, History 60%, Indonesian 50%, Occult 40%, Tobelo 50%, Unnatural 10%

ATTACKS: Unarmed 40%, damage 1D4-1.
Heavy flashlight 40%, damage 1D4.

As a Cultist of the Faceless Mother, the Faceless Mother will not target Maria with her Orbs of Light.

Stefanus thinks he is more prepared to fight than he actually is for his cause. Though he cares deeply about his mother, he will not let her sacrifice for his life go down in vain -- he will remain in the cult's grasp unless the Agents convince him otherwise.

Stefanus Firmanda, Unrestful Soul

STR 11 CON 13 DEX 14 INT 10 POW 10 CHA 10

HP 12 WP 10 SAN 40

SKILLS: Alertness 40%, Anthropology 10%, English 50%, Indonesian 50%, Japanese 50%, Navigate 30%, Occult 20%, Survival 30%, Tobelo 50%, Unnatural 10%

ATTACKS: Unarmed 45%, damage 1D4-1.
Heavy flashlight 45%, damage 1D4.
Pocket knife 35%, damage 1D4, AP 3.

As a Cultist of the Faceless Mother, the Faceless Mother will not target Stefanus with her Orbs of Light unless Maria has been consumed.

Wednesday, May 4

The Entrance

Time: 12pm

The Agents and the campers arrive around the same time, parking their cars and motorbikes at the empty plot of land, or being dropped off by a tour agency who will return for them. It is very lively, and it smells like lunch.

Staff and volunteers welcome guests -- neither have uniforms, so they are indistinguishable from each other. Both staff and volunteers do the same tasks, so telling the public about the two groups is not a priority. They will only mention it if asked, or if a volunteer is asked about something only a staff member would know.

Maria Firmanda, a volunteer, identifies the Agents as a research team from Bulan Anggrek Nusantara, and welcomes them in English. She is a small Indonesian woman in her 50s. **HUMINT** notes her articulate and concise way of speaking. Having **HUMINT** 70% notes the fierce intelligence behind her bespectacled eyes -- in t-shirt and shorts, she seems a bit out of her element. She marks their names off and tell the Agents to speak with her if they need anything.

Nothing of significance happens today. Everyone is friendly and socialises amongst themselves. Volunteers came earlier and have set up camp. Staff members sleep below the office. Campers choose where they would like to set up camp, and staff/volunteers help if needed.

The Agents have until the fourth night before the campers and staff are fed to the Faceless Mother.

Bonfire Night

Campsite bonfire

Time: 6pm

Dinner is served around the bonfire. Beers are being passed around by the tourists. The adult campers make relaxed conversations. The teenagers huddle together, some grumbling about the bad signal. The only two children gather around Maria Firmanda, letting their parents finally catch a break.

Maria treats the children to smores and entertains them with spooky stories in Indonesian. Agents can either sit in or eavesdrop with **STEALTH**. **INDO** 50% can identify her accent as not being from Kalimantan. This combined with **ANTRHO/INDO** 60% can identify her being from Maluku.

She tells a ghost story about children being lured away by witches through songs and promises of fun, only to be fed to Rangda, a child-eating demon queen the witches serve. **ANTRHO/INDO** 50% identifies this as Balinese folklore. She ends with warning, *"So remember: never trust strangers. Do not answer their calls, do not follow them no matter how nice they seem, and never walk alone in the dark. Always be with your parents."* She will tell her ghost stories every night unless, as an ally, the Agents tell her not to, or if she is fed to the Mother.

Afterwards, the voice of a man from behind scolds her in Indonesian (**INDO** 50% same accent as Maria) for telling such stories before bedtime. This is her son, **Stefanus Firmanda**: a Japanese man in his 20s. But in the bonfire's light, Daniel sees his brother Eiji at the age he should have been (**SAN** 0/1). Agents with the appropriate **INT** can see the similarity between the two.

Stefanus has talked to his mother about Eiji's life. Thanks to the striking resemblance, both realise Daniel is Eiji's brother. They never thought they would encounter this problem and so are thrown off, quickly excusing themselves and whispering to each other in **TOBELO**.

Maria Firmanda

Hailing from Maluku, Professor Maria Firmanda is an expert at Indonesian anthropology, history, and mythology. Some years after Stefanus was conceived, her husband's weak heart succumbed to Becker muscular dystrophy. Unfortunately, Stefanus inherited his father's sickness and weakness. Maria moved to Jakarta for both her studies and for her son's health. She struggled to manage both at once and eventually stopped her studies due to financial issues and her son.

When Stefanus was 17, Kehidupan Kedua reached out to her for aid when she was in church. She gladly agreed and eventually was recruited into the Cult of the Faceless, giving Stefanus Eiji's consciousness. Both of their life forces combined nullified Eiji's own illnesses. The process mentally scarred both of them, but did not drive them to complete insanity like the other cultists.

Maria discovered records of the Faceless Mother's actions that date back to pre-colonisation Indonesia. Though each record described the Mother and her actions differently, and though the events were spread across the years and the country, they shared enough similarities for her to come to a conclusion.

Her current hypothesis is that the Faceless Mother is an O tokata, a malevolent spirit of the dead from her hometown, Tobelo, that she and her community believe in. Knowing the Faceless Mother's behaviours, she thinks the Mother is a fusion of the two types. O tokata o honganino come from the forest and induce nightmares, and O tokata o tonakino come from the ground. She swears by witnessing the O tokata "Suanggi" in 2004, the vengeful spirit of a Muslim girl who was brutally murdered and worse during Maluku's Christian-Muslim conflict in 1999-2000.

Maria knows what she did to her child was very wrong and regrets it, but is also (disturbingly) relieved her son will not have a premature death like his father. She has also seen what the cult does to its traitors and is highly paranoid. However, she can be **convinced** to be an ally: Agents can roleplay or make appropriate checks to tip Maria over to the Agents' side, as long they promise to keep her son safe.

Whether it's through speaking in English, being very vague, or secluding the agents, Maria is very discrete in sharing what she knows and trying to convince the Agents she speaks the truth. Besides information about the Faceless Mother, Kehidupan Kedua, and Stefanus, she shares:

- She is from the charity Kehidupan Kedua, and so are the other volunteers here. They are the Cult of the Faceless and serve who they call the Faceless Mother, or who she thinks is an O tokata.
- The charity heads are the ones who actually initialised the camp with goal is to feed the campers to the O tokata as it is the start of her new feasting cycle, hence not wanting to associate Camp Delima with the charity.
- She is unaware of the Fish & Chips concert incident.

- Her superiors in the charity are suspicious about Bulan Anggrek Nusantara. She doesn't know why, but everyone was told to watch them closely.
- She is unsure whether the waterfall staff are also part of the cult.
- Volunteers patrol the forest through the night to ensure no one escapes and no one discovers the Mother too soon.

Stefanus Firmanda

Stefanus is a lot harder to convince. He is very worried about his mother's risky actions. He doesn't want either of them to leave the cult out of fear and to keep his mother safe: she had sacrificed so much for him, and he does not want it to be in vain. He is very suspicious of the Agents from the start. If the Agents convince Maria but not him, he is more likely to interfere, reporting the Agents while shielding his mother.

Stefanus is constantly plagued with the memories of a life that is not his and feels very guilty over seemingly stealing it. He recognises Daniel but pretends not to: **HUMINT** reveals this. He may also accidentally respond to "Eiji": **ALERTNESS** reveals this. Stefanus also has all of Eiji's skills, including being fluent in Japanese. **JPN** 50% is enough to match Stefanus' Japanese accent to Daniel's.

To **convince** Stefanus, it will be easier to convince his mother separately first. Trying to convince Maria and Stefanus together will make it easier to convince Maria but **harder** to convince Stefanus as he fights for Maria's safety. Should this happen, Stefanus will storm off. If the Agents do not try to stop or reconvince him, he will try to stop them.

Nightfall

The forest

Time: 9:30 pm

The volunteers patrol the forest. When catching the Agents for the first time, they will kindly lead them back to the campsite. If asked why they patrol, they simply respond with "Safety". The Mother does not show herself, though her **moult**s can be found.

SEARCH reveals what looks like a piece of flesh on the ground. Upon closer inspection with light, the flesh is raw and fresh with a network of red capillaries. Flipping it calls for **SAN** 0/1 violence except for Agent AJ, who gets **SAN** 1/1D4 violence. A girl's stretched face flops in the Agent's hand. Her lips part and come together like a the gills of a fish on land. Elisa's glassy, vacant eyes stare back at the Agent. More of these moult's can be found with increasing density as the days pass. This includes Kentaro.

Thursday, May 5

The Waterfall: Rafting

Time: 9am

After an early breakfast, some staff members and volunteers accompany campers upstream to the foot of the main waterfall. Staff and volunteer drag equipment along. Everyone going will be equipped with a **helmet**, a **life vest**, and an **oar**. Agents can choose to participate or not, though both staff and volunteers will try convince them to.

Each **inflatable raft** holds 7 campers/volunteers and 1 staff, who will sit at the back. The **staff** is trained in steering the raft and navigating rough waters (**SWIM** 50%, **ATHLETICS** 60%, **RAFT (ATHLETICS)** 60%; refer to Kehidupan Kedua Volunteer stat block for other stats). If the Agents decide to raft, a **raft volunteer** intentionally takes longer to prepare. The Agents will board the raft much later than the others, isolating them from everyone else.

This **raft volunteer** (same stats with **SWIM** 60%, **UNARMED** 50%.) will steer for them. He is a full-out psychopath, a great actor, and very loyal cultist. He was personally told to make an '**accident**' happen to the Agents by intentionally losing control, steering the raft into rocks, flipping the raft, and others. He will risk his own life, if needed.

The rafting course runs far past the camp site and is decently intense. The dangerous right side is lined with a wall of **large rocks**. The safer left side also has rocks between the river and **solid ground**. People are able to walk along this path to the end of the course. The river itself has **strong currents** rushing around **rocks in the river**. The course will also counter **two more waterfalls**.

🎵 *Jungle Drums - Half Life*

These are very opportune moments for bad accidents to happen! Swimming through this course call for **SWIM**.

1. Start: the currents at their strongest push them down the river immediately.
2. Fast rapids over rocks: the volunteer will badly navigate over the rocks. **STR** to not lose the oar to a rock or the current. At the end of this segment, the volunteer will 'accidentally' lose his oar.
3. Steep waterfall: the easiest place for an accident to happen. The Agent at the back can attempt **ATHLETICS** and the other Agents with oars can attempt **ATHLETICS** (or -20% if less than half have oars) to regain control and navigate down the waterfall safely. Of these Agents, half need to succeed to be safe. Otherwise, the raft will crash and everyone will be thrown into rocks, water, or both. Check **STR** to stay onboard or **SWIM** or **DODGE** -20% to be 'safely' thrown overboard. Failure throws the Agent overboard and deals 1D4 damage. A fumble deals 4 damage and stuns the Agent.
4. Calm rapids: the right side of the course is now filled with fauna, and the current is much calmer. The volunteer apologises and asks to borrow a remaining oar, if any. He can either retain his cover until the end. If he doesn't, he will drag an Agent overboard and try to **drown** them (**SWIM** or **UNARMED/DODGE** -20% to contest volunteer's **UNARMED** -20%, using an **oar** (1D4-1) to speed up the process if needed. Drowning Agents roll **CON** 1/1D4 each round.
5. Small waterfall: the volunteer, if he's alive and if the Agents even make it here, will make no attempt at harming the Agents. This waterfall is significantly lower, very wide, and free of rocks. The worse that can happen is being thrown into the calmer water that runs just below waist-level.

There are already additional staff waiting down here to help navigate rafts to the rocky shore. Most campers would already be walking back to the campsite. Some play in the water or loiter around until the last raft arrives. Most of the rafts and oars have already been loaded onto a truck to send back to camp.

Back at the entrance, towels, wedang jahe, and lunch is served -- along with first aid, if needed.

Mother's Lullaby

The forest

9:30 pm

If **Stefanus** isn't convinced but knows **Maria** is, he will wait for the Agents to be alone and will confront them. Volunteers patrol as usual. Getting caught twice confirms the volunteer's suspicions: next time, they will capture them and feed them to their Mother. Starting from this night, the **Mother**, too hungry to wait, is active. She will prey on whoever she comes across (besides volunteers) and continues to moult.

Friday, May 6

The entrance: trekking

Time: 8am

Campers, staff, and volunteers will be driven out of the camp and up the mountain where the trek begins. The trail, after many stone stairs, leads to a pool at the foot of another waterfall where people can swim and take pictures. Afterwards, the campers will be taken to a small village, where they will have lunch, and to a rice paddy field before returning. If the Agents choose to come, no attempts on their lives are made here.

 *I Gotta Get Out of Here - Rusty Lake Paradox*

If the Agents remain, a group of volunteers (equal to the number of Agents staying + 1) will also remain. There will always be staff at the camp to look after the place. If the Agents have been suspicious enough, they may be abducted (all at once, or one by one) to be fed to the Mother.

Death to the Traitors

The forest

11:00 pm

 *Nepal Monastery - Half Life*

Maria can be outed as a traitor either due to trying to save the campers/Agents (she knows the Agents know something), or due to working with the Agents. **ALERTNESS** catches the sound of rustling of a tent and multiple footsteps going from the campsite into the woods: Maria has been knocked unconscious and is being carried into the forest. If she is successfully sacrificed, the Agents will recognise her face stretched across the Mother, and the Mother will also target Stefanus when possible.

Discovering Maria's preventable death costs **SAN** 1/1D6 (Helplessness).

Saturday, May 7

The last day is left free for the campers to relax, redo the activities, or play by the water. These campers will go in groups and will always be accompanied by at least one staff and one volunteer.

Maria dies: depending on Stefanus' relationship with the Agents, he will either blame them for his mother's disappearance or beg them to help find her. In this heighten state of emotions, "Eiji" slips out by suddenly calling Daniel "Onii-San". Regardless of the circumstance, Stefanus is struck with guilt and shame -- enough to be convinced by the Agents to help, if he is not already an ally. He knows what his mother does except for her anthropology/history research. If the Agents do not stop him, he will join the search (and eventually the fight).

Maria lives, but so does Mother: Maria and Stefanus will help the Agents with their directive to kill the Mother to the best they can. If the Agents have not pieced together what Dani's lone face on the Mother means, they will tell them.

In either case, the surviving Firmanda(s) will try stall the 'firefly' viewing for as long as possible.

You Would Not Believe Your Eyes

The Forest

Time: 11pm

 Prisoner Pod - Half Life: Alyx

In this moment of new discovery, a special connection strings through all the campers. The staff, happy to partake in this historical moment as a free break, chat among each other. Friends fall in stride with one another, bubbling with quiet laughter. Smiling couples, under the fir-covered sky, link their arms together. The two children squeal with delight, darting about the rocks and trees of this natural playground, as everyone is swallowed whole by darkness.

There are no stars tonight. The moonlight has been cut into useless slivers that scatter on the forest ground like dead leaves. The campers were also told to put away their phones to not scare away the fireflies until they were certainly there. The only source of light come from the volunteers stalking the back of the crowd, herding and tightening the campers like wolves from behind with their heavy flashlights, ensuring no one slips past their net woven from the campers' threads of fate.

The flashlights click off, stranding everyone in darkness. The campers stop by instinct and begin to murmur. A mother and father hold onto their children tightly. Brock turns around, asking where the lights went. Anggi, eyes widening with wonder, shushes them.

Out of nothing, one after the other, soft lights glow into existence -- alluring, tantalising, hypnotising. The volunteers remain as the campers walk towards the growing orbs lights, hands slipping from grips, phones ignored and forgotten. The wind's whispers caress their cheeks like a Mother's touch. It calls out to them, calls out to them to rest in the sweet warmth of a Mother's embrace, forever.

Shadows flicker. The campers stagger as something cuts their brains.

Outcomes

Sunday, May 8

Depending on what the Agents discover and how things progress, there are some things that could happen at the end. Regardless of what happens, campers and volunteers leave the camp from morning to noon. Staff return to their homes at the village in the evening. If the campers are infected, none are comatose and they recover easily from the attack.

The Agents Fail

The Agents fail to stop Mother from infecting the campers and staff. They will eventually spiral into a coma, just like Dani and Eiji. Whatever the agents do, the volunteers will also not try to stop them: their Mother will slowly form herself back together through the new consciousness she has acquired. Killing Dani also does nothing to stop the Mother's return. Wracked by guilt, Agents lose **SAN 1D4/1D8** (Helplessness).

The Firmanda Trials

Regardless of the outcome, if there are any surviving Firmanda, they will be no more. The cult will make them disappear after the camp without a trace. The implications of this (and perhaps the Agents realising their negligence) cost them **SAN 1/1D4** (Helplessness).

The only way to save the Firmandas is to offer Melati's protection. Melati will learn of the cult through interviews and the Agents' reports. A team will be assigned to both protect the Firmandas and use them as bait to lure and weed out the cult. Kehidupan Kedua and Biji Muda quickly dissolve as cultists scatter into hiding. They will then be hired as Agents due to their knowledge and/or involvement with the Unnatural.

Dani's Fate

 *Adagio - Fantasia*

Dani's pulse is exceedingly weak as the Faceless Mother is solely leeching off their life force. Though Dani's death ensures the Faceless Mother's death and the safety of countless people in the future, Dani's blood stains the Agents' success.

Before taking her child off life support, Novri holds her child's hand. She will ask AJ to do the same. Off life support, Dani's pulse begins to weaken as Novri comforts them, saying they have been strong and no longer need to fight. However, Dani's pulse will stall. Novri tells AJ that she thinks Dani is waiting for him, and that he needs to tell Dani it's okay to let go.

You hear the long, unbroken beep of the heart Monitor. You can't be certain, AJ, whether it was real or imagined, but for the slightest second, Dani's warm fingers shift in your hand before it settles there forevermore.

Somewhere on the Kalimantan mountains, an creature of ancient time crumbles into dust. All that remains of it is a piece of flesh that too will eventually be claimed by the soft soils.

- The Agents kill the Mother at the cost of personally killing Dani: +1D8-4 SAN (Helplessness)
- Agent AJ personally makes the decision to kill Dani costs **SAN 1D6/1D8** (Helplessness).

Dani's Rescue

Clever players may piece together that stopping Dani's heart temporarily may (and will) kill the Faceless Mother while potentially saving Dani. However, in their weak comatose state, stopping blood flow to the brain (inducing a stroke) will have severe consequences. (If Dani dies, SAN loses from the previous section apply.)

Roll **CON** to determine how Dani survives:

- 88%, 99%, or 100%: Dani's heart does not start again.
- 81-98%: Dani is back to square one -- they will be comatose for 1D6 weeks and will wake up with mental problems, communication difficulties, and will have lost almost all motoric functions.
- 61-80%: Dani wakes up mentally intact, but has lost almost all motoric functions. They will have to relearn speech and writing.
- 1-60%: Dani wakes up with hemiplegia -- paralysis of the right/left half of their body.
- Crits from 77% to 11%: Dani wakes up with their muscles atrophic, but is otherwise fine.

Roll **POW** 40% to determine if Dani develops Depression (regardless of the outcome, it is a lot to process in a single day):

- Failure: Dani is Depressed. In what felt like a moment of darkness, the world has moved on 11 years, two of their closest friends are dead, they have financially drained and emotionally burdened their mother and AJ, and they have missed their entire 20s. They further spiral as more imposed burdens and missed moments come to mind.
- Dani lives (61-98%): +1D8 SAN, AJ +1D8-5 SAN (Helplessness)
- Dani lives (1-60%): +1D10 SAN, AJ +1D8 SAN
- The best outcome where Dani is perfectly fine: +1D10 SAN for everyone